BOOK POLITICS

PARLIAMENT & LAWS

How members of parliament propose laws, the 24-hour vote, what each law type does, and the executive and diplomatic powers around them.

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THE CHAMBER

Parliament seats are won in elections. A party's seats go to its own members in a fixed order — the leader first, then the secretaries, then the members by the date they joined — and an empty seat fills itself the moment a new member joins. The seated members (MPs) and the president are the only players who can propose and vote on laws.

The Parliament page has four tabs:

- **Chamber** — the seats, the laws in voting and the recent laws.
- **Cabinet** — the president and the four ministers.
- **Government** — shown only to office holders: the desks of the offices they hold (see Government Offices & Elections).
- **Floor** — parliament's own chat (see below).

A vote belongs to the seat. Only the president and the players holding a seat right now are counted. If an MP loses their seat while a law is in voting, their ballot stops counting, and the seat's new holder can cast its one vote.

PROPOSING A LAW

Press **Create New Law**, pick a category, then a law type; each type shows a short description before you submit. Every MP — and the president — can have **one law in voting at a time**.

CATEGORY	LAW TYPES
Economy	New building · Set a tax rate · Set the notary fee · Change the currency · Government FX order · Remove FX order · Ban an export · Lift an export ban
Foreign affairs	Open / close borders · Propose an alliance · End an alliance · Impose an embargo · Lift an embargo · Propose a trade agreement · End a trade agreement
Interior	Move the capital · Resize parliament · Set immigration policy · Adopt a state ideology
Territory	Declare a region independent · Sell / cede a region
Defense & Attack	Declare war
General	Rename the state · Change state color · Change the flag
Other	Transfer budget · Call early parliamentary election · Call early presidential election
Regime	Become a dictatorship · Restore democracy (only the one that applies is offered)

Three more types — **Accept an alliance**, **Accept a trade agreement** and **Accept a region purchase** — never appear in this list. They are opened from an incoming offer by the official who received it (see *Diplomacy* below).

THE VOTE

Every proposal runs a **24-hour ballot**. Each voter picks **Yes**, **No** or **Abstain**, and can change that choice until the ballot settles.

- A law passes when **Yes votes outnumber No votes**. Abstentions count for neither side, and a tie fails.
- **Sovereignty acts need a two-thirds majority**: declaring independence, selling a region and accepting a region purchase pass only when Yes votes are at least two thirds of the Yes and No votes cast.
- **Become a dictatorship** has the highest bar of all: Yes from **two thirds of every eligible voter** — the president and every seat holder, rounded up. Abstaining or not voting counts as No.
- A passed law **takes effect at once** — taxes change, borders flip, the flag updates, or the war begins the moment the ballot settles.
- Its conditions are checked again at that moment. If one no longer holds — the treasury can no longer pay, the target region changed hands, an offer lapsed — the law is marked **Failed**, with the reason, instead.
- Everyone affected is notified: war declarations, for example, alert both countries' citizens.

A ballot can end **before** the 24 hours run out:

- **Everyone voted** — once every eligible voter has cast a ballot, the law settles immediately.
- **An authorized official signs it** — when the president or the responsible minister (see the table below) votes **Yes** on a law their office could enact directly anyway, the wait ends and the law settles with the votes as they stand.
- **The outcome becomes certain** — when the remaining voters could not change the result even by voting together (say, 11 Yes among 21 voters), routine laws settle on the spot. For Become a dictatorship that moment comes when Yes reaches two thirds of every eligible voter, or no longer can. **Deliberation laws are exempt** and always run their full window unless everyone has voted or an official signs: war declarations, independence, region sales and purchases, currency changes, and early-election calls.

The Chamber tab shows the laws in voting with their live tallies. **Recent laws** (and **View all**, the last 30 days) list every settled law as **Executed**, **Rejected** or **Failed** with its votes, and mark laws that skipped the vote as "enacted directly".

EXECUTIVE POWER

Some laws don't need a vote when the right office acts. When an authorized official opens **Create New Law**, the form offers **Enact now** for these types — with a link to send it to a parliamentary vote instead — and the ministry desks on the Government tab enact them in one click. The change takes effect at once and is recorded as "enacted directly":

LAW	WHO CAN ENACT IT DIRECTLY
Set a tax rate	Economy minister or president
Set the notary fee	Economy minister or president
Government FX order / Remove FX order	Economy minister only
New building	Economy minister only
Change the currency	President
Open / close borders	Foreign minister or president
Move the capital	President
Propose / end an alliance	Foreign minister or president
Impose / lift an embargo	Foreign minister or president

LAW	WHO CAN ENACT IT DIRECTLY
Propose / end a trade agreement	Foreign minister or president
Ban an export / lift an export ban	Economy minister or president
Set immigration policy	Interior minister or president
Declare war	Defense minister or president

Sovereignty acts — independence, region sale, region purchase — deliberately have **no direct path**: land moves only by parliamentary vote. The rest — renaming, colour, flag, resizing parliament, ideology, budget transfers, early-election calls and Become a dictatorship — always go to the chamber. Any MP can still put any of the types above to a normal vote.

Under a dictatorship the Leader needs no vote: every law the Leader signs is a **decree** in force at once (see Parties & Elections).

WHAT EACH LAW DOES

ECONOMY

- **New building** — builds **1 to 25** of one building type in one of the state's regions. It costs gold from the treasury plus all seven raw materials from the state stockpile, and both must be there when the law takes effect. The buildings and their costs are on Infrastructure & Region Capacity.
- **Set a tax rate** — sets the income, import, production or export tax anywhere from **0% to 50%** (see Markets, Tax & FX).
- **Set the notary fee — 5, 10, 15 or 20 gold** (5 for a new state): the fee the treasury charges on every contract one of the state's citizens takes part in.
- **Change the currency** — switches to another currency already in use in the world. The currency can change only **once every 30 days**, and every open listing on the local market is cancelled at the switch, its goods returned to the seller.
- **Government FX order** — posts a treasury-backed order to buy or sell gold for one currency on the FX market, at a set rate and number of lots. A state keeps at most one buy and one sell order per currency; a new order for the same currency and side replaces the standing one. **Remove FX order** takes one down.
- **Ban an export** — stops the state's citizens from listing one item on the global market, or handing it to a foreigner by contract. The country's live global listings of that item come down at once and the goods

go back to their sellers, who are notified. Raw materials, food, weapons, tickets, components and ships can be banned; the local market and buying from abroad are untouched. **Lift an export ban** reverses it.

FOREIGN AFFAIRS

- **Open / close borders** — closed borders admit only the state's citizens and holders of a work permit for it. New states start with open borders. Keeping them closed burns **2 grain and 1 oil per owned region per minute** from the state stockpile; when the stockpile runs dry they open on their own and the president is notified. See Travel, Permits & Moving Abroad.
- **Alliances, embargoes and trade agreements** — see *Diplomacy* below.

INTERIOR

- **Move the capital** — to another region of the state, at most **once every 30 days**. It is blocked while the capital is being fought over, and during the 30-day window after the capital falls in war.
- **Resize parliament — 20, 40 or 60 seats** (new states start with 20). The seats are divided again at once on the votes of the last parliamentary election.
- **Set immigration policy** — **Manual**: the interior office reviews every work-permit application (the default). **Automatic**: applications are approved on arrival, and switching to Automatic approves the waiting queue at once — except applicants who already hold two permits.
- **Adopt a state ideology** — Nationalism, Socialism, Liberalism or Conservatism, each a flat bonus in every region of the state; it can change again **30 days** after adoption. See Parties & Elections.

TERRITORY

- **Declare a region independent** — frees one region as a new sovereign state: its citizens become the new state's citizens, and it starts its own election cycle. At most **one independence every 7 days**.
- **Sell / cede a region** — offers one region to another state for a price in gold, or for nothing (a cession). Passing the law sends the offer; the buyer then decides (see *Diplomacy* below). Only one sale offer per region can be pending.

Neither act can give up the **capital**, the state's **last region**, a region that is **being fought over**, or any region while the capital-loss window runs after the capital fell.

DEFENSE & ATTACK

- **Declare war** — names a **staging region** of your own and a **target region**: a neighbour across a land border, or — by sea — any coast on the same water. An optional reason of up to **280 characters** goes with it. The target can be another state's region or an independent one, but never an active ally's, and

never a region under protection. A region can be part of only one war, or one declaration in voting, at a time. A passed declaration opens the front immediately, notifies both sides' citizens, and ends any trade agreement between the two states. See War & the Front.

GENERAL

- **Rename the state** (2–40 characters), **Change state color** (its colour on the world map) and **Change the flag** (an uploaded image).

OTHER

- **Transfer budget** — sends gold, currency, or stockpiled raw materials, food, weapons and tickets from the treasury to another state.
- **Call early parliamentary election** — opens a parliamentary ballot immediately, in place of the scheduled one; the 14-day cycle then runs on from it. Refused while a parliamentary ballot is already open.
- **Call early presidential election** — opens a presidential ballot immediately. It needs a sitting parliament (the candidates come from its parties) and is refused while a presidential ballot is scheduled or open.

REGIME

- **Become a dictatorship** — possible only once the sitting president has **won three presidential elections in a row**; the form shows how many so far. It passes only with Yes from two thirds of every eligible voter. The president becomes the Leader, and parliament, the ministries and elections end.
- **Restore democracy** — the Leader's own decree; a parliamentary election follows. Both are explained in Parties & Elections.

DIPLOMACY

Diplomacy is run by the **foreign minister or president** — enacted directly from the Government tab or the law form, or proposed as a **Foreign affairs** law any MP can put to the chamber.

- **Propose an alliance** — offers another state a **90-day** non-aggression pact. The other state must accept within **3 days**, or the request lapses. While the pact is active, neither side can declare war on the other.
- **Renew** — in an active pact's final **14 days**, either side's foreign minister can press **Renew +90d** on the Foreign Affairs desk to add another 90 days; the other side is notified. Both governments get a reminder when a pact enters its **last week**. Renewing is a direct act, not a law.
- **End an alliance** — either side ends the pact at once.

- **Impose an embargo** — hides both states' global-market listings from each other and blocks contracts between their citizens. Only the state that imposed it can lift it, and it ends any trade agreement between the two.
- **Lift an embargo** — restores that visibility.
- **Propose a trade agreement** — offers another state **30 days of zero import tax in both directions**. It is blocked while an embargo stands either way, or while an agreement or an offer between the two is already live. An embargo or a war between the partners **ends an agreement automatically**, and an agreement never renews itself — after it expires, a new one is proposed.
- **End a trade agreement** — either side ends it early.

ANSWERING OFFERS

Incoming alliance requests arrive on the **Foreign Affairs** desk; trade and region offers on the **Diplomatic offers & trade** desk.

- An **alliance request** is accepted or rejected directly on the receiving state's Foreign Affairs desk; a **trade-agreement offer**, by the receiving president or foreign minister. Either can instead be handed to parliament with **To parliament**, which opens an Accept vote (simple majority).
- A **region-sale offer** is never accepted directly. Only the receiving **president** can put it to parliament, as **Accept a region purchase** (two-thirds majority). The price is taken from the buyer's treasury when that law passes — if the treasury cannot pay, the law fails — and the region changes hands together with its citizens.
- Trade-agreement and region-sale offers lapse after **7 days**. The proposing side can withdraw a pending offer: a trade offer by its president or foreign minister, a region sale by its president only.

Every act is **public record**. A country profile's diplomacy section lists its allies, embargoes, trade agreements and export bans, each with the other state's flag and its dates. The governments involved are always **notified** (proposals, acceptances, rejections, renewals, expiries, embargoes, sales), and alliances, embargoes, trade agreements, region sales and independence declarations are **announced in the community Discord**.

THE PARLIAMENT FLOOR

The **Floor** tab is parliament's chat for debating the bills. MPs and the president can post, up to **500 characters** a message; every citizen of the country can read along. Messages are kept for **7 days**.

← PREVIOUS
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NEXT →
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